

How to Use Your Listing SEO Audit

SKU MKT-001 • LISTING SEO AUDIT

What this workbook does

Scores your Airbnb / VRBO listing against 25 ranking criteria — title, photos, description, amenities, response time, reviews, calendar hygiene, pricing rules, instant-book settings, host signals. Each criterion is pass/fail with a fix-instruction. Output: a prioritized fix list ranked by impact.

Search rank is the single biggest lever for an STR listing that exists but isn't booking. Most "low occupancy" problems are actually "low search-rank" problems. This workbook is the audit you run before you change anything else.

First-time setup (10 min)

1. Open tab **Listing Snapshot** — paste your Airbnb / VRBO listing URL, current title, current top photo, last 30-day occupancy, average response time.
2. Tab **Audit Checklist** — walk the 25 criteria one by one. For each, mark Pass / Fail and add a one-line note.
3. Tab **Re-audit Tracker** — log today's date as "Audit 1." Future re-audits add Audit 2, Audit 3 columns to track improvement.

The 25 criteria — what they cover

- **Title (3 criteria):** keyword density, length, character utilization
- **Photos (5):** hero photo composition, total photo count, caption coverage, exterior + amenity coverage, photo recency
- **Description (3):** opening hook, amenity bullet density, length
- **Amenities (3):** filtered-amenity coverage, premium-amenity claims, accuracy
- **Pricing rules (3):** min-stay strategy, weekend pricing, gap-night pricing
- **Calendar hygiene (3):** availability runway, recently-blocked dates, instant-book setting
- **Host signals (3):** response time, response rate, review count + score
- **Search rank levers (2):** booking velocity, last-30-day occupancy

Reading the outputs

- **Audit Score:** total Pass count out of 25. Healthy listings score 20+. Below 15 indicates a listing that's effectively invisible.
- **Fix List:** every Fail row sorted by impact. Top 5 should fix in week 1; remainder over weeks 2-4.

- **Estimated Rank Lift:** workbook's estimate of search-rank improvement per fix. Use this to prioritize.

The work flow

1. Audit. Mark every Pass / Fail honestly.
2. Pick the top 3 highest-impact fixes from the Fix List. Implement this week.
3. Wait 14 days for Airbnb's search-rank algorithm to re-evaluate.
4. Re-audit. Compare scores. Track which fixes moved which metrics.
5. Repeat.

Common patterns

- **Title fail + photo fail = no bookings.** Fix these first; everything else is downstream.
- **High audit score but low occupancy** → not a search-rank problem. Run the Cleaning Fee Optimizer (REV-001) and Dynamic Pricing Calculator (REV-002).
- **Audit score improves but occupancy doesn't** → you're in a market that's softening. Check FIN-001 RevPAR Dashboard against your comp set.

Questions?

hello@thestrledger.com — real humans, fast replies.

Upgrade path: The Full version on thestrledger.com expands to 40 criteria + a sourced Methodology tab + Top-5 Comp Compare. The Marketing Bundle pairs it with the Review Response Tracker (MKT-002) and Referral / Repeat-Guest CRM (MKT-003).